CITIZENSHIP

MEMBERSHIP → ARTICLES 5-11 → ACQUISITION → LOSS → SECTION 6A → OCI/CAA → 2026 PROCEDURE → PYQS → ANSWER SPINE → VERDICT

Read the thick stem rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artifacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g16 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CITIZENSHIP: MEMBERSHIP, RIGHTS AND SINGLE NATIONAL STATUS

MEMBERSHIP, RIGHTS AND SINGLE NATIONAL STATUS · PERSON WITHIN INDIA · +-- POLITICAL MEMBERSHIP OF INDIA · +-- CITIZEN-ONLY RIGHTS · ARTICLES 15, 16, 19, 29 AND 30 · +-- ELIGIBILITY FOR SPECIFIED CONSTITUTIONAL OFFICES · ALIEN PERSON-BASED GUARANTEES INCLUDE ARTICLES 14, 20 AND 21 · PERMANENT LEGAL HOME PLUS INTENTION

PERSON WITHIN INDIA

+-- political membership of India → +-- citizen-only rights: Articles 15, 16, 19 and 29; Article 30 says minorities → +-- eligibility for specified constitutional offices

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PERSON WITHIN INDIA
- +-- political membership of India
- +-- citizen-only rights: Articles 15, 16, 19 and 29; Article 30 says minorities

POWER / PROCEDURE
- +-- eligibility for specified constitutional offices
- ALIEN person-based guarantees include Articles 14, 20 and 21 may be foreign national or stateless person
- DOMICILE + permanent legal home plus intention

CHECK / LIMIT
- RESIDENCE = factual presence under a specified rule
- CITIZENSHIP = legal-political membership
- SINGLE CITIZENSHIP = national equality of membership across Union and States

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- +-- eligibility for specified constitutional offices

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Citizenship is the legally recognised membership of the Indian political community; it links allegiance and protection, allocates political voice and selected public offices, and remains principally statutory after the Constitution's commencement settlement.

01

STAGE 01

ARTICLES 5-7: COMMENCEMENT CITIZENSHIP DECISION TREE

ARTICLES 5-7 · COMMENCEMENT CITIZENSHIP DECISION TREE · AT COMMENCEMENT, 26 JAN 1950 · ARTICLE 5 · DOMICILE IN INDIA + ONE CONNECTION BIRTH IN INDIA · PARENT BORN IN INDIA · FIVE YEARS' ORDINARY RESIDENCE · ARTICLE 6

AT COMMENCEMENT, 26 JAN 1950

ARTICLE 5: domicile in India + one connection birth in India → parent born in India → five years' ordinary residence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- AT COMMENCEMENT, 26 JAN 1950
- ARTICLE 5: domicile in India + one connection birth in India

POWER / PROCEDURE
- parent born in India
- five years' ordinary residence

CHECK / LIMIT
- ARTICLE 6: migrated from Pakistan to India before 19 Jul 1948 → ordinary residence route on/after 19 Jul 1948
- → registration after permit-era conditions

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ARTICLE 7: migrated to Pakistan after 1 Mar 1947 generally excluded permit for resettlement/permanent return may restore Article 6 route
- Five-year residence alone never satisfied Article 5: domicile remained essential.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 5-8 identified citizens at commencement. Article 9 disqualified voluntary foreign citizenship for the specified commencement routes, Article 10 continued status subject to law, and Article 11 empowered Parliament to build the permanent statutory regime.

02

STAGE 02

ARTICLES 8-11: OVERSEAS ORIGIN, CONTINUITY AND PARLIAMENT

ARTICLES 8-11 · OVERSEAS ORIGIN, CONTINUITY AND PARLIAMENT · ARTICLE 8 · INDIAN ORIGIN ABROAD + REGISTRATION BY INDIAN DIPLOMATIC OR · ARTICLE 9 VOLUNTARY FOREIGN CITIZENSHIP BLOCKS ARTICLES 5, 6 · ARTICLE 10 COMMENCEMENT CITIZENSHIP CONTINUES SUBJECT TO PARLIAMENTARY LAW · ARTICLE 11 · PARLIAMENT REGULATES ACQUISITION, TERMINATION AND ALL CITIZENSHIP MATTERS

ARTICLE 8

Indian origin abroad + registration by Indian diplomatic or consular officer → ARTICLE 9 voluntary foreign citizenship blocks Articles 5, 6 and 8 claim → ARTICLE 10 commencement citizenship continues subject to parliamentary law

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 8
- Indian origin abroad + registration by Indian diplomatic or consular officer

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ARTICLE 9 voluntary foreign citizenship blocks Articles 5, 6 and 8 claim
- ARTICLE 10 commencement citizenship continues subject to parliamentary law

CHECK / LIMIT
- ARTICLE 11
- Parliament regulates acquisition, termination and all citizenship matters

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CITIZENSHIP ACT 1955
- Constitution settled founding membership; statute governs the continuing regime.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The application could be made before or after commencement, subject to the Government of India's prescribed form and manner.

03

STAGE 03

FIVE STATUTORY ROUTES TO ACQUIRE CITIZENSHIP

FIVE STATUTORY ROUTES TO ACQUIRE CITIZENSHIP · CITIZENSHIP ACT 1955 · BY BIRTH · DATE AND PARENTS' STATUS · BY DESCENT · PARENT LINK + DATE-SPECIFIC REGISTRATION CONDITIONS · BY REGISTRATION · LISTED CATEGORIES AND RESIDENCE CONDITIONS

CITIZENSHIP ACT 1955

BY BIRTH: date and parents' status → BY DESCENT: parent link + date-specific registration conditions → BY REGISTRATION: listed categories and residence conditions

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CITIZENSHIP ACT 1955
- BY BIRTH: date and parents' status
- BY DESCENT: parent link + date-specific registration conditions

POWER / PROCEDURE
- BY REGISTRATION: listed categories and residence conditions
- BY NATURALISATION: Third Schedule qualifications and discretion
- BY INCORPORATION: Central Government specifies eligible persons

CHECK / LIMIT
- NO ROUTE IS AUTOMATIC MERELY FROM long residence
- voter document
- PROCESS statutory category → exact date → documents → oath and decision

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- BY REGISTRATION: listed categories and residence conditions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAA 2019 inserted a proviso for its specified class, subject to the statutory exemptions.

04

STAGE 04

BIRTH AND DESCENT RULES CHANGE ACROSS DATES

BIRTH AND DESCENT RULES CHANGE ACROSS DATES · BY BIRTH IN INDIA · 26 JAN 1950-30 JUN 1987 BIRTH GENERALLY SUFFICIENT; EXCEPTIONS · 1 JUL 1987-2 DEC 2004 AT LEAST ONE PARENT · BY DESCENT OUTSIDE INDIA BEFORE 10 DEC 1992 PATERNAL · 10 DEC 1992-2 DEC 2004 EITHER INDIAN PARENT CAN · A DOCUMENT PROVES FACTS; IT DOES NOT OVERRIDE THE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
BY BIRTH IN INDIA	1 Jul 1987-2 Dec 2004 at least one parent must be Indian citizen from 3 Dec 2004 one	BY DESCENT OUTSIDE INDIA before 10 Dec 1992 paternal transmission under then text	A document proves facts; it does not override the date-specific statutory test.
26 Jan 1950-30 Jun 1987 birth generally sufficient; exceptions apply	citizen parent + other not illegal migrant, or both parents citizens	10 Dec 1992-2 Dec 2004 either Indian parent can transmit from 3 Dec 2004 consular registration and declaration controls	BY BIRTH IN INDIA

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- BY BIRTH IN INDIA
- 26 Jan 1950-30 Jun 1987 birth generally sufficient; exceptions apply

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 1 Jul 1987-2 Dec 2004 at least one parent must be Indian citizen from 3 Dec 2004 one
- citizen parent + other not illegal migrant, or both parents citizens

CHECK / LIMIT
- BY DESCENT OUTSIDE INDIA before 10 Dec 1992 paternal transmission under then text
- 10 Dec 1992-2 Dec 2004 either Indian parent can transmit from 3 Dec 2004 consular registration and declaration controls

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- A document proves facts; it does not override the date-specific statutory test.
- BY BIRTH IN INDIA

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Citizenship by birth changed across statutory periods, so proof of birthplace alone cannot establish citizenship without applying the contemporaneous parental-status conditions.

05

STAGE 05

THREE ROUTES OF LOSS AND THEIR SAFEGUARDS

THREE ROUTES OF LOSS AND THEIR SAFEGUARDS · RENUNCIATION ADULT CITIZEN'S DECLARATION · MINOR CHILD MAY FOLLOW, WITH STATUTORY RESUMPTION PROTECTION · TERMINATION VOLUNTARY ACQUISITION OF ANOTHER COUNTRY'S CITIZENSHIP · INDIA DOES NOT RECOGNISE FULL DUAL CITIZENSHIP · CENTRAL GOVERNMENT ORDER FOR SPECIFIED GROUNDS FRAUD OR CONCEALMENT · CITIZEN ACT · FOREIGN ACQUISITION

RENUNCIATION adult citizen's declaration

minor child may follow, with statutory resumption protection → TERMINATION voluntary acquisition of another country's citizenship → India does not recognise full dual citizenship

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- RENUNCIATION adult citizen's declaration
- minor child may follow, with statutory resumption protection

POWER / PROCEDURE
- TERMINATION voluntary acquisition of another country's citizenship
- India does not recognise full dual citizenship

CHECK / LIMIT
- Central Government order for specified grounds fraud or concealment disloyalty or unlawful enemy dealing specified conviction or residence
- conditions notice, inquiry and public-good control renunciation + citizen act

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- termination + foreign acquisition
- deprivation = State order

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The common shorthand "deprivation applies to registered and naturalised citizens" is incomplete because the Act contains express inclusions and exclusions.

06

STAGE 06

ASSAM SECTION 6A: CUT-OFFS, CONSEQUENCES AND JUDICIAL CONTROL

ASSAM SECTION 6A · CUT-OFFS, CONSEQUENCES AND JUDICIAL CONTROL · ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A ENTERED BEFORE 1 JAN 1966 DEEMED · NRC USES 24 MARCH 1971 MIDNIGHT AS ASSAM'S CUT-OFF · IN RE · IN RE: SECTION 6A (2024) — 17 OCTOBER · 1 JUDGMENT UPHOLDS SECTION 6A; IMPLEMENTATION REMAINS CRUCIAL · NATIONAL MEMBERSHIP + ASSAM MIGRATION HISTORY + CULTURAL PROTECTION

Assam-specific Section 6A entered before 1 Jan 1966 deemed citizens under statutory scheme entered 1 → Mar 1971 detection + registration ten-year electoral-roll exclusion entered on/after 25 Mar 1971 no Section → NRC uses 24 March 1971 midnight as Assam's cut-off reference. → IN RE: SECTION 6A (2024) — 17 OCTOBER → 4:1 judgment upholds Section 6A; implementation remains crucial.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A entered before 1 Jan 1966 deemed citizens under statutory scheme entered 1 Jan 1966-before 25
- Mar 1971 detection + registration ten-year electoral-roll exclusion entered on/after 25 Mar 1971 no Section 6A protection

POWER / PROCEDURE
- NRC uses 24 March 1971 midnight as Assam's cut-off reference.
- IN RE: SECTION 6A (2024) — 17 OCTOBER

CHECK / LIMIT
- 4:1 judgment upholds Section 6A; implementation remains crucial.
- TENSION: national membership + Assam migration history + cultural protection.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A entered before 1 Jan 1966 deemed citizens under statutory scheme entered 1 Jan 1966-before 25
- Mar 1971 detection + registration ten-year electoral-roll exclusion entered on/after 25 Mar 1971 no Section 6A protection

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Section 6A creates an Assam-specific citizenship settlement with differentiated cut-offs, but it confers Indian citizenship rather than any separate Assam citizenship.

07

STAGE 07

OCI AND CAA: CONNECTION IS NOT CITIZENSHIP

OCI AND CAA · CONNECTION IS NOT CITIZENSHIP · OCI LIFELONG VISA-RELATED AND NOTIFIED BENEFITS NOT DUAL CITIZENSHIP · CAA FACILITATION SIX COMMUNITIES · HINDU, SIKH, BUDDHIST, JAIN, PARSI, CHRISTIAN THREE COUNTRIES · AFGHANISTAN, BANGLADESH, PAKISTAN ENTRY · ON OR BEFORE 31 DEC 2014 SPECIFIED IMMIGRATION EXEMPTION · FIVE INSTEAD OF ELEVEN YEARS FOR SPECIFIED CLASS TERRITORIAL

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
OCI lifelong visa-related and notified benefits not dual citizenship; no vote or constitutional-office entitlement	before 31 Dec 2014 specified immigration exemption + application conditions naturalisation aggregate five instead of eleven years for	ARTICLE 14 DEBATE	Challenge: religion/country exclusions, under-inclusion, secularism and Assam impact
CAA FACILITATION six communities: Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi, Christian three countries: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Pakistan entry: on or	specified class territorial exclusions apply	State: neighbouring theocracies, minorities and humanitarian classification	SOURCE STATUS: 2019 Act and 2024 Rules operative; no located final merits judgment.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- OCI lifelong visa-related and notified benefits not dual citizenship; no vote or constitutional-office entitlement
- CAA FACILITATION six communities: Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi, Christian three countries: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Pakistan entry: on or

POWER / PROCEDURE
- before 31 Dec 2014 specified immigration exemption + application conditions naturalisation aggregate five instead of eleven years for
- specified class territorial exclusions apply

CHECK / LIMIT
- ARTICLE 14 DEBATE
- State: neighbouring theocracies, minorities and humanitarian classification

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Challenge: religion/country exclusions, under-inclusion, secularism and Assam impact
- SOURCE STATUS: 2019 Act and 2024 Rules operative; no located final merits judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 19 August 2026 Collector route changes Section 6B administration for specified territories; it does not change the CAA eligibility class or 31 December 2014 cut-off.

08

STAGE 08

DOCUMENT PROOF AND EXACT PRELIMS PYQ CONTROLS

AADHAAR ≠ CITIZENSHIP PROOF · 2018 Q12: NEITHER 1 NOR 2 · 2021 Q89: 1 ONLY · PASSPORT / EPIC: EVIDENCE, NOT UNIVERSAL CONCLUSIVE PROOF

CONTROL	EXAM USE
Aadhaar	not citizenship proof
2021 Q89	1 only; key provenance qualified

RULE / EVIDENCE
- Aadhaar does not by itself prove citizenship or domicile
- 2018 GS-I Q12 tests proof and deactivation

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT
- 2021 GS-I Q89 tests one citizenship/domicile, President and deprivation

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A document may evidence identity, entry or residence, but only the governing constitutional or statutory rule determines citizenship.

09

STAGE 09

2025 OCI CANCELLATION AND 2026 SECTION 6B PROCEDURE

SECTION 7D(DA): SERIOUS-CRIMINALITY OCI CANCELLATION GROUND · G.S.R. 742(E): SPECIFIED APPLICANTS APPLY TO COLLECTOR · S.O. 4583(E): PENDING APPLICATIONS TRANSFER TO COLLECTOR · S.O. 4583(E): PENDING APPLICATIONS TRANSFER TO COLLECTOR

Section 7D(da): serious-criminality OCI cancellation ground

G.S.R. 742(E): specified applicants apply to Collector → verify documents -> enquiry -> oath -> decision → S.O. 4583(E): pending applications transfer to Collector

RULE / EVIDENCE
- Section 7D(da): serious-criminality OCI cancellation ground
- G.S.R. 742(E): specified applicants apply to Collector

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT
- verify documents -> enquiry -> oath -> decision
- S.O. 4583(E): pending applications transfer to Collector

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCI and CAA remain statutory statuses; current procedure must be stated precisely without converting administrative change into a change of citizenship eligibility.

10

STAGE 10

EXECUTABLE 10 / 15 / 20-MARK ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10: DEFINE + THREE ANCHORS + CAVEAT + VERDICT · 15: CONSTITUTIONAL SCHEME + STATUTE + JUDGMENT/DEBATE · SPECIFIC IMPROVEMENT FOLLOWS EVERY SOLVED ANSWER · SPECIFIC IMPROVEMENT FOLLOWS EVERY SOLVED ANSWER

10: define + three anchors + caveat + verdict

15: constitutional scheme + statute + judgment/debate → 20: both sides + named evidence + 2026 status + safeguards → specific improvement follows every solved answer

RULE / EVIDENCE
- 10: define + three anchors + caveat + verdict
- 15: constitutional scheme + statute + judgment/debate

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT
- 20: both sides + named evidence + 2026 status + safeguards
- specific improvement follows every solved answer

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A high-scoring citizenship answer separates membership, evidence and procedure, then tests statutory choices against equality, liberty and federal accommodation.

11

STAGE 11

QUALIFIED SYNTHESIS: LAWFUL MEMBERSHIP UNDER REVIEW

CONSTITUTIONAL FOUNDING SETTLEMENT · PARLIAMENTARY STATUTORY ADMINISTRATION · EQUAL MEMBERSHIP + LAWFUL CLASSIFICATION + FAIR PROCEDURE · EQUAL MEMBERSHIP + LAWFUL CLASSIFICATION + FAIR PROCEDURE

constitutional foundling settlement

parliamentary statutory administration → judicial review and natural justice → equal membership + lawful classification + fair procedure

RULE / EVIDENCE
- constitutional foundling settlement
- parliamentary statutory administration

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT
- judicial review and natural justice
- equal membership + lawful classification + fair procedure

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian citizenship law is constitutionally founded, statutorily administered and judicially reviewable; legitimacy depends on equal membership, lawful classification and fair procedure.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · A. CITIZENSHIP IS A GATEKEEPING STATUS, NOT MERELY A · B. FRATERNITY AND EXCLUSION PULL IN OPPOSITE DIRECTIONS · C. EQUALITY REVIEW MUST IDENTIFY THE COMPARATOR · D. TEMPORAL REASONABLENESS AFTER THE SECTION 6A DISSENT · E. NATIONAL MEMBERSHIP AND FEDERAL ASYMMETRY · F. OCI AS CALIBRATED EXTERNAL MEMBERSHIP · G. POLITICAL THEORY CROSS-LINK - BOUNDED ENRICHMENT ONLY

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- A. Citizenship is a gatekeeping status, not merely a rights bundle
- B. Fraternity and exclusion pull in opposite directions
- C. Equality review must identify the comparator
- D. Temporal reasonableness after the Section 6A dissent

ADVANCED LIMIT
- E. National membership and federal asymmetry
- F. OCI as calibrated external membership
- G. Political Theory cross-link - bounded enrichment only
- H. A citizenship decision has at least four review layers

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- That is why apparently technical rules about dates and parentage also decide who participates in democratic authorship.
- Fraternity and exclusion pull in opposite directions (ANALYSIS): A citizenship law can advance fraternity by integrating long-settled populations,
- yet weaken it if classification appears to stigmatise another group.
- The Section 6A majority treated historical accommodation as fraternity-consistent

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels